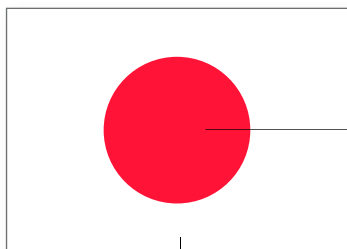


Japan

Ratio: 7:10 **Adopted:** January 27, 1870 **Usage:** National and Civil

The sun symbol has been an element in Japan's flags for thousands of years



The red disc is named Hinomaru or disc of the Lucky Sun

The white field expresses honesty and purity

Asia



Isolated from the world for centuries, **Japan** began to modernize in the 19th century. After defeat in World War II, it became a democracy.

Japan is known as “The Land of the Rising Sun.” The Emperor of Japan and his predecessors descend from the House of Yamato, which united the country in AD 200 and they claim to be direct descendants of the sun goddess, Amaterasu Omikami.

The current flag was officially established as the national flag of Japan in 1870.

THE HINOMARU

The Lucky Sun or *Hinomaru*, in the center of the flag, has been an imperial badge since the 14th century. The white field stands for purity and integrity, and some suggest the red disc represents brightness, sincerity and warmth. The Japanese Maritime SDF ensign is an unusual adaptation of the national flag.

JAPANESE MARITIME SDF ENSIGN

Adopted in 1889, the naval ensign consists of the sun-disc with red rays extending to the border of the flag



Rays extend to the edge of the flag to recall the rising sun